

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**FRENCH
LIBERALISM**



19th WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 1

ALL EXAMS

8th May to 14th May, 2017



FRENCH ELECTION ... 1st ROUND



EMMANUEL MACRON
EN MARCHÉ PARTY

24%



MARINE LE PEN
NATIONAL FRONT PARTY

21.3%



FRANÇOIS FILLON
REPUBLICAN PARTY

20%



JEAN-LUC MÉLENCHON
LA FRANCE
INSOUMISE.

19.6%

*The top 2 contenders have gone for 2nd round of
polling, which took place on 7th May*





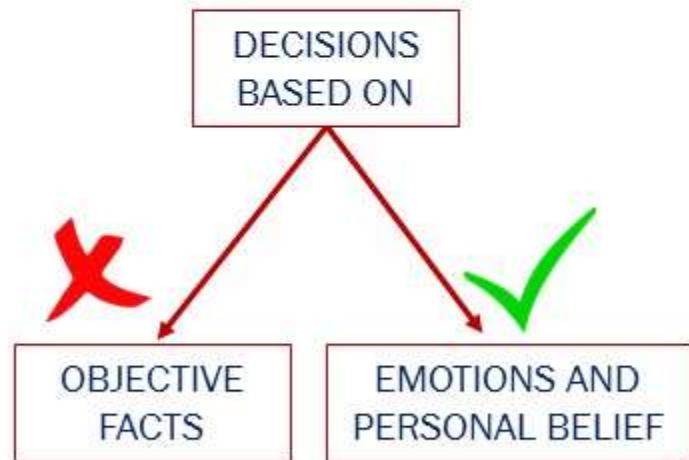
HATE CRIME

Hate crime is bias motivated crime (prejudice motivated) which occurs when a perpetrator targets a victim because of his/her sex, ethnicity, language, nationality, religion, gender identity or sexual orientation

XENOPHOBIA

Fear or hatred of strangers or foreigners

POST-TRUTH



EXAMPLES IN 2016

1



BREXIT

2



DONALD TRUMP
(VICTORY)

EMIGRANT & IMMIGRANT



NATIONALISM



USA



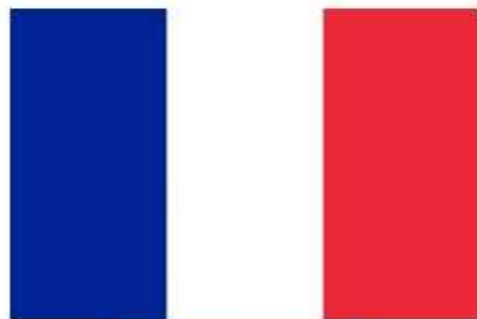
UK

- Loyalty and devotion to the nation state
- Surpassing other individual or group interests
- Sense of national consciousness
- Exalting nation above all others
- Placing primary emphasis on promotion of the culture and interests

NATIVISM



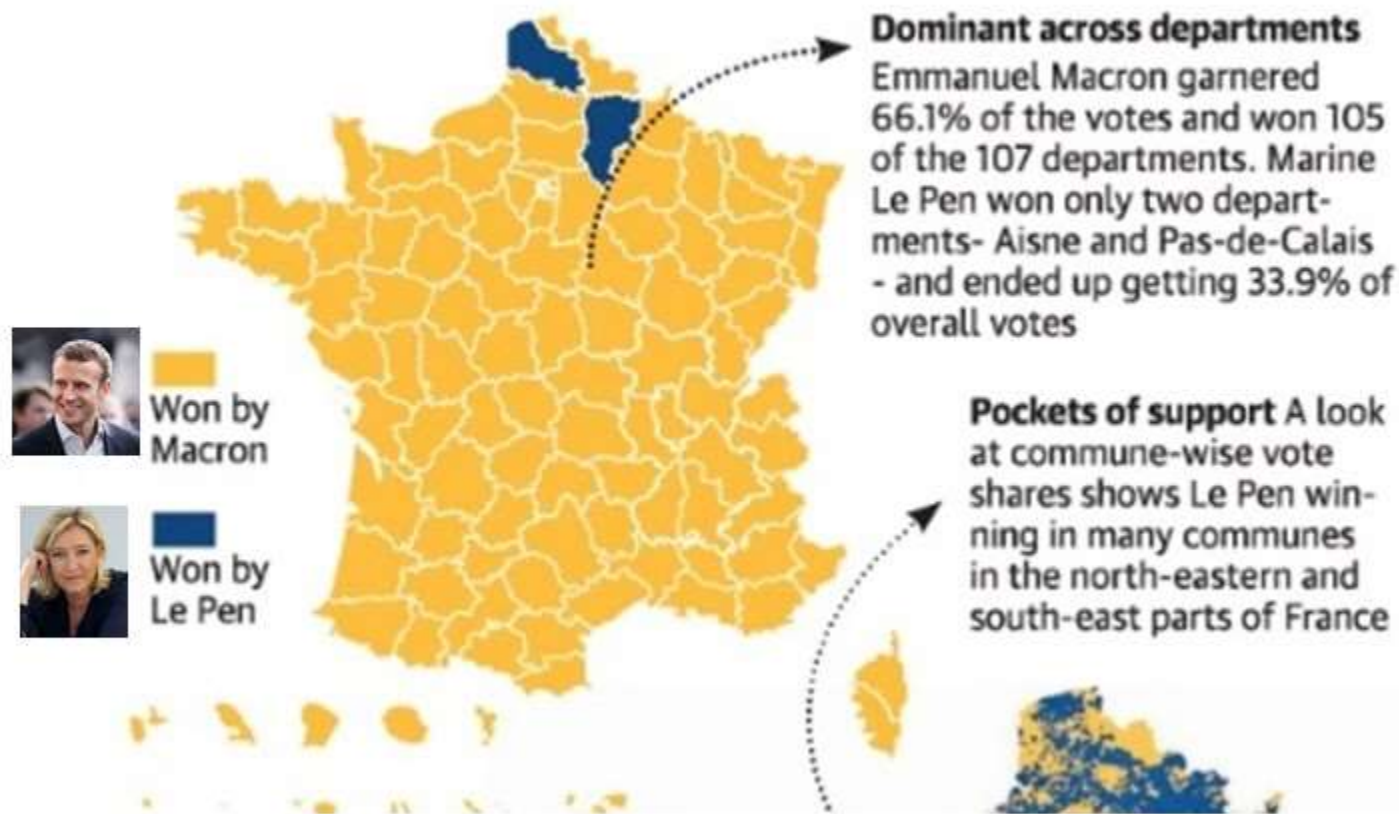
USA



FRANCE

- It is the political idea that people who were born in a country are more important than immigrants
- Immigrants are the people, who have come to live in the country from somewhere else

FRENCH ELECTION ... 2nd ROUND



FRENCH ELECTION ... 2nd ROUND

Second round results over the years (%)

Year	Republicans	Socialists	En Marche	National Front
1988	46	54	-	-
1995	53	47	-	-
2002	82	-	-	18
2007	53	47	-	-
2012	48	52	-	-
2017	-	-	66	34

Le Pen's platform - stopping immigration and her anti-EU sentiments fetched her support in places with high unemployment and low wages and which have witnessed significant deindustrialisation over the years



PROMISES BY EMMANUEL MACRON



EMMANUEL MACRON
EN MARCHÉ PARTY

- 1** Cut 1,20,000 public sector jobs and bring down the budget deficit. Cut public spending by € 60 bn in 5 years.
- 2** A € 50 bn public investment plan to cover job-training, and shift to renewable energy
- 3** Slash corporation tax from 33% to 25%
- 4** Bring down unemployment from 10% to 7%.
- 5** Unify the pension system
- 6** Bolster EU ties and the Eurozone, higher tariffs to protect European industry
- 7** Common border force



En Marche !

Emmanuel Macron



Marine Le Pen



FRANCE ELECTIONS ... DECISIVE VERDICT

- 1 In the French elections, in the second round, people gave a decisive verdict.
- 2 Emmanuel Macron got 66% against Marine Le Pen's 34%.
- 3 The voter turnout is the lowest in the 40 years as per the news reports.
- 4 In the French elections, traditional socialist and republican parties could not reach the second round.
- 5 Marine Le Pen did well in rural parts of northern and eastern France.



En Marche !

Emmanuel Macron



Marine Le Pen



FRANCE ELECTIONS ... DECISIVE VERDICT

- 6 Mr. Macron won in 105 administrative regions, where as Marine Le Pen won in just two.
- 7 90% of voters in the capital city Paris, voted for Emmanuel Macron.
- 8 The vote share of Front National increased from around 18% in 2002 to 34% is a significant development.



WHAT ARE THE PRESENT DAY PROBLEMS?



En Marche !

Emmanuel Macron



- 1 There is widespread discontent among voters.
- 2 Youth are not happy with the mainstream political elite.
- 3 Joblessness is very high.
- 4 Insecurity among the citizens after the multiple terror attacks.

RISE OF FRANCE'S YOUNGEST PRESIDENT



Emmanuel Macron

En Marche !



- 1 Emmanuel Macron's rose from a civil servant-turned-Rothschild investment banker to a popular presidential candidate.
- 2 Three years ago, he was appointed Economy Minister by President Francois Hollande. Subsequently, he quit Mr. Hollande's government and founded a new movement 'En Marche' in April, 2016.
- 3 His party claims neither left nor right.
- 4 He favours liberal economic reforms, including cutting public expenditure and amending the country's labour code.



THE SIGNAL IT GIVES TO THE WORLD AS A WHOLE!



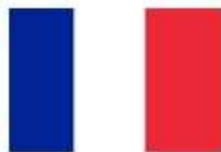
- 1 The election is a check on the forces of economic protectionism, xenophobia and Islamophobia.
- 2 People thought that France elections will be a continuation of various events taking place during the past one year like the Brexit referendum and the Victory of Donald Trump.
- 3 It is renewed, even if limited, support for lower trade, investment and immigration barriers.
- 4 It is the vote, which confirms that there is no immediate threat to the European Union.
- 5 It may influence the elections in Germany, which are scheduled during the later part of the year.



Overall, it is the pause for far-rightists, protectionists, Anti-immigration policies, nationalistic, nativist winds prevailing across the world in several advanced countries, if not the defeat.



WHAT LIES AHEAD?



- 1 Going ahead, there are several challenges like job creation, satisfying the aspirations of small town-rural-hinterland people.
- 2 Automation may further widen the gap between haves and have-nots, that is elites and rural hinterland people.
- 3 GDP is struggling to grow for the past several years.
- 4 Failure of Emmanuel Macron could mean that anti globalization forces, both on the extreme right and left may emerge with renewed vigour.



The world leadership should lead to reshape globalization in a more acceptable and inclusive way with regulatory checks and balances. It is to be seen whether France will show the way for more acceptable globalization.

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